

What's coming, and what's open

Prepared for the Teams call on Thursday 27 August, 10 AM. What MVE has coming, how busy they really are, and where a structural engineer is not on public record — so that *“what have you got coming up?”* gets a specific reply. Sourced and dated; revised 26 August 2026.

+7.4% headcount in six months

Dallas — two roles, no Texas office

OCVIBE: 13 consultants, none structural

Onni — the warmest thread

× THREE RULES BEFORE THE CALL

“Not publicly named” does not mean the seat is open. It means no public record names a structural engineer. Every line here is a reason to ask a question, never a reason to assert one.

This document does not go to MVE. It ranks their projects by how little is locked down and names the engineers who already hold their work. It is a hunting sheet and it reads like one. The agreed leave-behind position from the prep call was *nothing* — tools discussed verbally, no code, no screens.

The tools are bait, not the offer. Jim’s own words: *“the only reason I brought it up was to spark interest, and he bit right away.”* KOR is not selling software on this call; the goal is to get back on the proposal list and to learn what is coming. Do not raise the virtual-engineer or virtual-drafter work.

QUESTION ONE

Are they getting busy? Yes — and here is the number

The clearest public measure is how often a new MVE project surfaces in the Los Angeles development press: **one in all of 2024, two in 2025, and four in the first eight months of 2026** — plus three LA projects in active construction. That is what Dan means.

The headcount says the same thing, and says it more precisely: they are growing, and the growth is speeding up.

WINDOW	HEADCOUNT GROWTH	WHAT IT MEANS
Six months	+7.4%	The recent half-year added more than the half before it
Twelve months	+5.2%	—
Twenty-four months	+14.8%	Steady underlying growth

Estimated headcount around 120. **Eight roles are advertised right now** — read from their own ADP portal and LinkedIn, last seen 25 August: an HR Manager, a Project Lead and a Project Manager in Irvine, a Job Captain in Los Angeles, a BIM Coordinator in Guadalajara, and two for Dallas. An earlier “~20 roles” figure came from a job aggregator and is not supported by the primary feed.

▲ DALLAS IS THE FRESHEST THING IN THIS BRIEF

A **Project Lead** and a **Job Captain**, both advertised for “*Remote — Dallas, Texas*” on **21 August 2026** — five days ago. **MVE has no Texas office**. Hiring a project lead and a job captain into a market where you have no studio is what a firm looks like when it is staffing a project there or standing one up. It is in no trade press. Ask about it.

Orange County billings rose 25% to \$28.1M in 2025 (OCBJ), and they hold **#8 in Orange County** and **#14 in Los Angeles County** (\$24.5M LA billings, 2025 — LABJ 2026). Two senior non-design hires this year: a Director of Marketing & Strategy in March, and their first General Counsel in July. The HR Manager opening is the third — a firm putting its scaffolding in.

Five offices, settled from their own contact page (read 26 August): Irvine, Los Angeles, San Diego, San Francisco, and **Guadalajara, Mexico**. Four California studios and one in Mexico — **no US office outside California**, which is what makes Dallas interesting. Guadalajara is a real studio, not a back office: it has a named director on the leadership page (Liliana Bernardis Valenzuela) and is currently hiring a BIM Coordinator. Denver, opened 2022, is not listed; there is no closure announcement and none should be assumed.

× THE EXCEPTION — SAN DIEGO IS NOT BUSY YET

Rongé’s studio opened with 10 staff, and the only two projects he has ever publicly named as its work are 4002 Park Blvd and The Becker — one in framing, one in plan check. **Not one of the eight open roles is in San Diego**. His 15–20 target lands around January 2027. Congratulating them on San Diego’s momentum would be a misread.

Who is on the call — and who is merely at the firm

Three people from MVE are on Thursday’s Teams call, and only three: **Dan Gura**, who organised it, **Ken Yahampath**, who is on the To line, and **Matthew McLarand**, who is copied and may not join. Everyone below the rule is *not* an attendee — they are who you would be routed to if the conversation goes anywhere, and they are listed so a name landing in the call is not a surprise.

▲ KEN YAHAMPATH – THE NAME THAT WAS MISSING

Business Operations Analyst / Resource Coordinator, at MVE about a year, and **not on their public leadership page** — which is why an earlier draft of this brief wrongly reported that MVE has no internal technology function. In his own words: *“I work largely with **ERP** and our leadership team to formulate optimal work plans for **maximum utilization and accountability**. I also work with most of the other company data to report on and strategize to increase efficiencies.”*

He runs **DelteK Vantagepoint** (the ERP), **Mosaic**, and a **HubSpot CRM** of roughly 800 contacts. Dan Gura routed both of the technical questions in the email thread straight to him. **He is the person who knows how busy MVE actually is** — which is the single thing this call is meant to find out.

NAME	TITLE	WHY THEY MATTER IF IT GOES ANYWHERE
Pieter Berger , AIA NCARB	Principal + Director of Design, Irvine / OC	The structural-selection voice on Orange County work. If OCVIBE comes up, this is who knows the answer.
Chase Rongé , AIA NCARB	Principal + Director of San Diego	Runs the studio with no publicly named engineer on any of its work. ▲ Ex-Carrier Johnson — see section 6.
David Arnold	Director of Finance and Operations, Irvine	The commercial seat. Fee structure, terms and anything procurement-shaped route through him rather than through a principal.
Kenneth Nilmeier	Principal + Director of Planning, Irvine	25-year staffer. On a \$4B master plan, not a minor name.
Luis Arambula , NCARB	Principal + VP of Architecture, Irvine	Production leadership — the closest published thing to a delivery-and-standards owner.
Charles Pigg	Director of Business Development, Utah	Salt Lake. New geography for them.
Janet Dennerline	General Counsel, Irvine	Joined July 2026 — their <i>first</i> . A firm that has just hired its own counsel is formalising how it contracts, which is worth knowing before terms are discussed.

▲ HOW MVE DECIDES — FROM THE PREP CALL

MVE runs shared decision-making. Matthew does not make all the calls, so the route in is to cultivate the project architects under him. Jim has already worked with **Luis Arambula, Pieter Berger** and **Paul Kearney**. The history to draw on: an LA tower that never got built, plus two towers Jim delivered with MVE while he was at Glotman.

► WHAT THE DEPARTMENT SHAPE TELLS YOU, AND WHAT IT DOES NOT

Against **27 staff in arts and design**, MVE carries **four in engineering and six in operations**. It is a design studio with a thin back office — consistent with a firm that **buys in technical disciplines rather than holding them**, and with a General Counsel and an HR Manager both arriving this year.

⚠ **The commercial databases show zero staff in IT, and that is an artefact, not a fact.** Ken Yahampath does exactly that work and appears in none of them, because he is absent from the public leadership page. **Never say or imply that MVE has no technology function** — the person who would hear it is on the call. Treat the department figures as a rough shape and nothing more.

QUESTION TWO

Where the structural seat looks genuinely open

Ranked by *stage × size × how little is locked*. The top row changed on 26 August, on the strength of a document filed with the City of Anaheim.

#	PROJECT	WHERE · CLIENT	SIZE	STAGE	STRUCTURAL
1	OCVIBE Residential Phase I	Anaheim · H&S Ventures	530 u	Final Site Plan filed 10/2025, NOD 02/2026	Thirteen consultants named in the filed directory. Structural is not one of them
2	Santa Clara Park (2518 Mission College)	Santa Clara · The Irvine Company	1,792 u · 2.85M sf	Council-approved 03/2025. Start waits on the leases in the dozen offices it replaces	not publicly named — landscape and civil are
3	Legacy Park	Mesa, AZ · Vestar / Pacific Proving	2,500 u · 750 keys	Entitlement ahead, groundbreak 2027	not publicly named
4	6201 Residences	Culver City · RCB / REDA	846 u	Approved 10/2025, start targeted 2026	not publicly named
5	Riverwalk at Studio City	Los Angeles · Genton / RC / Torino	814 u	Approved 06/2026, construction late 2027	not publicly named
6	5350 Wilshire	Los Angeles · Onni	419 u · 46 st	Draft EIR 30 July 2026 — freshest filing found	not publicly named
7	Mosaic	Long Beach · Turnbridge / Waterford	628 of 900 unbuilt	Entitled	not publicly named
8	Belhaven	Salt Lake City · Blox Ventures	1,497 u, 84 delivered	Phased	not publicly named

▲ WHY OCVIBE IS NOW FIRST

The entitlement set MVE's client filed with Anaheim in October 2025 carries a full project directory. It names the applicant, the agent, **smith-clementi** as master plan architect, **MVE + Partners as architect**, Fletcher Studio for landscape, Fuscoe for civil, Pirzadeh for traffic, Hunsaker for master planning, Holmes for the fire master plan, 3d-identity for signage, Moran for dry utilities, Water Concern for irrigation — and **NMG Geotechnical**. Thirteen disciplines, geotechnical among them, and **no structural engineer listed. John A. Martin & Associates does not appear.**

A final site plan does not always require the structural consultant to be named, so this is not proof of an open seat. But it is the closest thing in this brief to one, and it also confirms MVE's role from a city record rather than from their own website.

Also live and unlocked: the **Silos Hotel** (~150 keys) and three Silos retail buildings in Salt Lake, **Copper Hollow** in Layton, **Granary Square Phases II–IV**, **Downtown Daybreak**

later phases, and **Gateway Crossings Phases 2 and 3** (~925–1,065 units plus a 225-key hotel, entitled, not started).

QUESTION THREE

What to enquire about — announced work with no architect yet named

▲ ONNI – THE WARMEST THREAD ON THE TABLE, AND IT NEEDS ONE CHECK FIRST

The prep-call record has Dan asking Jim about “Ani”, and MVE appearing to have landed work with them. **“Ani” is almost certainly Onni** — it reached us through a call transcript, and Onni is the only reading that fits both firms. **△ Confirm the name before leaning on it.**

If it holds, three things line up at once. **KOR already works for Onni** — they are a live client and KOR’s strongest Vancouver-developer lever. **MVE is Onni’s architect on 5350 Wilshire**: 419 units, 46 storeys, Mid-Wilshire, and its **Draft EIR published on 30 July 2026**, four weeks ago. And **no structural engineer is on public record for it.**

One shared client, one live tower at exactly the stage where the engineer gets appointed, and a relationship on both sides of it. Nothing else in this brief is this warm.

► AVALONBAY IS BEING TAKEN OVER

It signed a merger agreement with **Equity Residential on 20 May 2026** — 2.793 EQR shares per AvalonBay share, former AvalonBay holders 51% of the combined company, closing expected in the second half of 2026, a new company name and dual headquarters in Chicago and Arlington. AvalonBay is a confirmed MVE client. **What happens to a development pipeline through a merger of that size is the most useful thing to ask them about**, and it is public and uncontroversial.

- **AvalonBay’s forward pipeline is 31 communities and 9,997 apartment homes** — that is the entire public disclosure. Their quarterly supplemental names every community *under construction* and none of the ones that are not. The four Californian ones are all already started, so all locked.
- **AVA Pacific Beach** — AvalonBay, **138 apartments** plus two parking structures on their own Ingraham Street site, **approved by San Diego City Council 23 February 2026**, not started, no architect publicly named.
- **The Plaza** — The Irvine Company, 552 units, San Diego.
- **Jamison’s four Koreatown / Westlake conversions** — ~1,086 units, no architect named on any.

- **Holland Partner Group's 380 Inverness (Denver) and Ballard (Seattle)** — past site plan, no architect reported. Holland is a repeat MVE client.
- **Riverwalk San Diego's remaining ~240 affordable units** — no developer or architect announced.
- **Riverwalk Phase 2+ — 17 of 20 parcels still undesigned**, and still not sequenced anywhere public: the site's own news feed has published nothing since the Q2 2026 update. MVE holds master planning and entitlements for the whole thing.
- **Hines' 276 for-sale townhomes at Riverwalk** — at grading, **architect not publicly named, so do not assume it is MVE.**

Kennedy Wilson / Toll Brothers — asked and answered, as far as the record goes.

The "29 sites, \$3.6B" figure is the September 2025 announcement. Kennedy Wilson's own filings restate what actually closed: **24 land-position purchase agreements with potential capitalisation of ~\$2.9B**, in staggered closings from December 2025 to January 2026. Their 10-K and 10-Q name only two development projects anywhere, both in the Mountain West. The site list is not published and there is no sign it will be — which makes it a good question to ask rather than a gap to keep researching.

QUESTION FOUR · PREPARATION ONLY

Who already holds the structural work

So you never ask about a filled seat. △ These are names to know, not names to say — and the first one must not be said at all.

ENGINEER

WHERE

The Vancouver firm — see section 6	Three MVE projects, not two. Ritz-Carlton Residences Newport Beach (22 storeys, 408 stalls); 3rd & Fairfax, Los Angeles; and 4002 Park Blvd, San Diego — their own project page describes it as a 21-storey tower “ <i>designed by MVE + Partners.</i> ” Never say this name.
Englekirk → WSP	Rafferty, Avalon West Hollywood, two executive-architect jobs. englekirk.com now redirects to wsp.com
Nelson Structural	Gateway Crossings Phase 1
DCI Engineers	Residences at Pacific City
SCA / NA & Associates	One Museum Square
Dunn Associates	Post District, Salt Lake
BHB Structural	The Silos, Salt Lake
Thornton Tomasetti	Seraph, Salt Lake (Hines)
John A. Martin & Associates	OCVIBE — at district level. They are not in the residential project directory

Salt Lake structural is locally held. That is a market-entry problem, not an open seat.

✕ SAN DIEGO — CORRECTED 26 AUGUST, AND IT CHANGES QUESTION 5

Three earlier passes concluded that *no* structural engineer was publicly named on any MVE San Diego project. **That was wrong, and the error was one of direction:** every pass searched from the project outwards. Searching from the *engineer* inwards finds it immediately — **the Vancouver firm’s own website lists 4002 Park Blvd**, and names MVE as its designer.

So the picture is split. **4002 Park has an engineer, and has had one since at least May 2024** (see section 6). **The Becker and the Riverwalk parcels still have none publicly named** — on The Becker the developer, architect, contractor and completion date are all published and the engineer is not, across four passes now. That remains an absence of publication, not an open seat.

⚠ **Ask question 5 knowing the answer to half of it.** If San Diego comes up and that name is said, it must not be news to you, and you must not follow it.

▲ IF THE CONVERSATION TURNS TO HOW WE WOULD ACTUALLY WORK TOGETHER

They run **Revit, Navisworks, Autodesk BIM 360 and Rhino** — and **Deltek**, the same ERP we do. Model exchange with them is a solved problem, not something either side would have to build.

Do not raise

× ONE NAME, AND ONE NUMBER

- **Never say “Glottman Simpson”.** They hold **three** MVE structural seats — Ritz-Carlton Newport, 3rd + Fairfax and the Hillcrest tower — and displacing them on MVE’s next Orange County high-rise is KOR’s own written number-one play. Naming a client’s incumbent engineer, in a meeting about wanting their work, reads as exactly what it is.
- **MVE’s revenue — do not state a figure, even a flattering one.** Published sources disagree, none is a filing, and the modelled figure could not be reproduced on a second pass. Quoting a client’s revenue back at them is bad in every direction, and here you would probably also be wrong.
- **Chase Rongé is ex-Carrier Johnson.** Worth knowing, never worth raising — Carrier Johnson is a firm KOR competes with in the same city.

And these are project facts — safe to know, wrong to raise as live work.

- **Discovery Park is not MVE’s.** The Irvine Company’s 1,858-unit Irvine entitlement is **BDE Architecture’s** — every architectural sheet in the plan set filed with the City of Irvine carries their title block. BDE is a San Francisco multifamily firm **with a San Diego office**. On their largest new entitlement, MVE’s oldest client chose someone else.
- **4002 Park Blvd (Pali) — the structural seat is not open.** San Diego’s permit record shows a building permit in plan check (\$47.1M, 21 storeys, 206 units) and **an ACI 318-19 code-deviation request issued in May 2024** — a structural submittal. An engineer has been engaged for over two years. It is also not stalled: gas services were cut in June 2025, the undergrounding permit has been in inspection since October 2025, and grading agreements issued on 30 June and 9 July 2026. It has not started vertical construction. It is not dormant either.
- **Park Summit is a different building** — a 21-storey tower on Balboa Park’s northwest corner, opened July 2026, JWDA architect. Easy to confuse with 4002 Park Blvd. It is not MVE’s.
- **Snug Harbor, Newport Beach — wounded, not dead.** The General Plan Amendment was **rescinded 6–0** (one recusal) after a petition gathered more than 6,100 valid signatures and the council chose rescission over the cost of a ballot. That killed the ~60,000 sf expansion; **the original 20,000 sf approval survives**, and MVE principals were still publicly discussing the design on **18 August 2026**. So do not congratulate, and do not commiserate either — a scaled-down version is live enough that they may be working on it right now.
- **Reserve at Silo Park — broke ground 14 October 2025.** Two developer websites still describe it as pre-development.

- **The Village at Riverwalk** (721 units) and **Riverwalk Central Village** — **Gensler**, not MVE.
 - **9th & Broadway / Celadon** — completed 2015, and two other firms also claim it.
 - **Uptown Newport** — not an Irvine Company project. Shopoff Management.
 - **350 Fig** and **920 S. La Brea** — entitled but dormant since 2020 and 2024.
 - **Terrence Seah**, previously the San Francisco studio director, no longer appears and has no listed replacement. **Do not mention him.**
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THE ASK

The questions, in order

Jim set the objective at the prep call, twice: *“Remind them we’re still in business, that you need to put us on your list. Find out what they’ve got coming up that we can help with — let’s get on that list and we’ll send you a proposal.”* Every question below serves that. The pipeline sections above exist so that when Dan says *“we have a few things coming”*, the reply can be specific rather than generic.

1

The whole objective

“You said you were busy — what’s coming up that you might need help on?”

Dan volunteered that they are busy; that is why this call exists. Everything else in this brief is here to make the follow-up to this one question specific.

2

The warmest thread

“Are you on the Onni tower at Wilshire and Cloverdale?” KOR already

works for Onni, MVE appears to have just landed Onni work, and 5350 Wilshire’s Draft EIR is four weeks old with no engineer named. [△](#) Confirm the Onni reference first — see section 4.

3

For Ken Yahampath

“Where does your resource picture get tight over the next couple of quarters?” He owns

utilization planning. The honest route to how busy they really are — and it opens the door for *“we have resources available.”*

#	ASK	WHY
4	"What do you need from us to get back on the proposal list?"	Ask it plainly, and ask Dan — he is the one who can action it. This is the outcome Jim named; do not leave the call without having put it.
5	"Who is doing structure on the OCVIBE residential buildings?"	530 units, MVE as architect on drawings filed with Anaheim, thirteen consultants named including geotechnical, and no structural engineer among them. The best-evidenced gap in this brief. Best asked of Matt or routed to Pieter Berger, not of Dan or Ken.
6	"What's taking you to Dallas?"	Two roles advertised for Texas on 21 August; no Texas office. Nobody has reported it. A flattering question that shows KOR pays attention, and it costs nothing.
7	"What has to happen before Santa Clara Park starts?"	1,792 units approved eighteen months ago. The public answer is that the Irvine Company is waiting out the leases on the offices it replaces. Landscape and civil are engaged; structural is not on record.
8	"How are you covering structural on the affordable and master-plan work in San Diego?"	⚠ Narrowed on 26 August. Do not ask it about San Diego generally — their Hillcrest tower already has an engineer, and it is the one name you cannot discuss. The Becker and the Riverwalk parcels are the genuinely unnamed work, and they are also the work that keeps coming. Salt Lake is locally held, which is a market-entry problem rather than a seat.
9	"How is the Sa cap in the 2026 code landing on your podium plates?"	⚠ Ask a design principal — Berger or McLarand — not Arnold. This is the one question that puts KOR in the room as an engineer rather than a supplier. It is their live problem and squarely our lane, and it is the natural bridge from <i>what are you building</i> to <i>who is engineering it</i> .
10	"What does the Equity Residential merger do to AvalonBay's pipeline?"	A client of theirs is being absorbed into a company half again its size, closing this half of the year.
11	"What came out of the Toll Brothers transition to Kennedy Wilson?"	24 land positions, ~\$2.9B, unpublished. They will know what they kept.

HONESTY

What is not established

No revenue figure is given here. Published sources disagree and none is a filing; the commercial database that supplied the growth percentages also carries a ~\$39M revenue estimate, and an estimate is not a number to quote at a client. The billings above are local, and labelled as such. The headcount figures are estimates too — it is the *direction and the acceleration* that carry the argument, not the absolute number.

× ONE ERROR THAT KEEPS PROPAGATING

That same database describes MVE as having **aviation work and projects in Egypt**. They have neither. Both claims were checked to exhaustion — zero matches across 74 live pages, ~140 archived pages and ~4,700 archived URLs. Directory blurbs repeat it. Do not let it into the room.

Still blocked: Culver City's project pages and Santa Clara's planning directory refuse even a browser request, so 6201 Residences and Santa Clara Park could not be read from their own city records.

▸ WHAT WAS RE-CHECKED ON 26 AUGUST, AND WHAT IT CAUGHT

Every name and title in section 2 was verified against MVE's live leadership page that day, along with the absence of any IT, BIM or technology title, and the absence of the former San Francisco studio director. The engineer attributions were checked from the engineers' own websites rather than from project coverage.

That reverse check is what found the San Diego error in section 5, and it is the one correction in this brief that would have changed what you said in the room. Two other claims were softened: **Snug Harbor** is not dead, and the **"no engineer anywhere in San Diego"** line was wrong. The Silo Park groundbreaking, the Snug Harbor vote and the Orange County ranking all held.

KOR Structural — MVE + Partners intelligence brief. Revised 26 August 2026. Confidential; prepared for Jim. The ~155-project portfolio history sits in the MVE company profile.

Where a structural engineer is **not publicly named**, that means no public record names one. It does not mean the seat is open.